NASA INTERNATIONAL SPACE APPS CHALLENGE 2026

ASTROVERSE · OFFICIAL FLIGHT PLAN

3-Day Comprehensive Hackathon Itinerary · 14–16 November 2026

BIAS BHIMTAL

EVENT VENUE
BIAS Bhimtal Campus
Nainital, Uttarakhand, India

MISSION WINDOW
14–16 November 2026
Continuous 3-Day Hackathon

PARTICIPATION MODE
Dual Track (Onsite + Virtual)
14 NASA Global Challenges

MISSION CONTROL & ORGANIZER CONTACTS

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DAY 01

SATURDAY, 14 NOV 2026 · MISSION LAUNCH & TEAM FORMATION
Reporting, grand inauguration, 14 problem statements overview, and hacking kickoff.

08:30 AM – 10:30 AM
Reception Desks

Participant Check-In, Verification & Kit Distribution

Onsite identity check, dual portal verification (NASA + BIAS-NSAC), and issuance of official identity badges.

10:30 AM – 11:45 AM
Main Auditorium

Grand Inaugural Ceremony & Keynote Address

KEY MILESTONE

Opening remarks by institute leadership, overview of the hackathon mission, and keynote by space mentors.

11:45 AM – 01:00 PM
Main Auditorium

NASA Space Apps Protocol & 14 Problem Statements Overview

Briefing on the 14 global challenge categories, official submission rules, evaluation criteria, and APIs.

01:00 PM – 02:00 PM
Campus Dining Hall

Networking Lunch & Onsite Team Matchmaking

Catered lunch. Solo participants and incomplete squads connect at designated matchmaking zone to finalize teams.

02:00 PM SHARP
Innovation Labs

Hacking Timer Commences: Development Sprint Begins

KEY MILESTONE

The mission begins! Teams claim workstation bays, initialize Git repositories, configure tools, and start building.

05:30 PM – 08:00 PM
Team Workstation Bays

Mentorship Round 01: Architecture & Feasibility Review

Domain experts and faculty mentors conduct 1-on-1 consultations at each team bay to review solution architecture.

08:30 PM – 09:30 PM
Campus Dining Hall

Dinner & Evening Recreation Break

Dinner served for all participants, organizers, and mentors to recharge spirits before continuing evening sprint.

IMPORTANT ARRIVAL ADVISORY:
All participants must report by 08:30 AM with their original Student ID Card, Government Photo ID, and laptop setup gear.

SPRINT, SUBMISSIONS, JUDGING & AWARDS

Detailed Timeline for Days 02 & 03 · Continuous Hackathon Schedule

DAY 02

SUNDAY, 15 NOV 2026 · SPRINT, SUBMISSION & EVALUATION

Full-day development sprint, technical mentorship, 6:00 PM submissions, and 8:00 PM live judging.

08:00 AM – 09:00 AM	*Campus Dining Hall*	**Breakfast & Morning Mission Sync** Fresh breakfast served. Morning sync with organizing coordinators regarding hardware and cloud environments.
10:00 AM – 01:00 PM	*Team Workstations*	**Mentorship Round 02: Prototype & Pitch Clinic** KEY MILESTONE Rigorous progress review. Mentors test working prototypes, review hardware circuits, and guide pitch presentations.
01:00 PM – 02:00 PM	*Campus Dining Hall*	**Lunch Break & Campus Decompression** Lunch break and leisure walk around the scenic Bhimtal campus before the final afternoon project polish.
02:30 PM – 05:30 PM	*Innovation Labs*	**Final Sprint, Documentation & Demo Video Preparation** Teams wrap up code, write technical README documentation, record demo videos, and craft presentation decks.
06:00 PM – 07:30 PM	*NASA & BIAS Portals*	**Project Submission Window & Official Code Freeze** KEY MILESTONE Submission window opens! Teams must submit repositories, demo links, documentation, and slides on both portals.
07:30 PM – 08:00 PM	*Dining Hall & Labs*	**Dinner & Presentation Rig Setup** Dinner served before judging. Teams test displays, hardware setups, and presentation decks.
08:00 PM – 11:30 PM	*Conference Halls*	**Jury Evaluation: Live Project Pitches & Q&A** KEY MILESTONE Judging officially commences at 08:00 PM! Teams present live demos followed by expert jury questioning.

DAY 03

MONDAY, 16 NOV 2026 · RESULTS, VALEDICTORY & FINALE

Official results declaration, valedictory ceremony, awards, and NASA Global Nominee advancement.

09:00 AM – 10:00 AM	*Campus Dining Hall*	**Breakfast & Morning Gathering** Breakfast served for all participants, faculty, jury members, guests, and organizing staff.
10:30 AM – 11:30 AM	*Main Auditorium*	**Jury Deliberation Debrief & Keynote Address** Insightful debrief by judges highlighting the most creative space applications built, followed by guest keynote talks.
11:30 AM – 01:00 PM	*Main Auditorium*	**Official Results Announcement & Award Presentations** KEY MILESTONE The big moment! Announcement of competition winners, track champions, trophies, and prize certificates.
01:00 PM – 02:00 PM	*Campus Dining Lawn*	**Celebratory Networking Lunch** Special celebratory lunch bringing together participants, mentors, faculty, and industry guests on campus lawn.
02:30 PM – 04:30 PM	*Main Auditorium*	**Grand Valedictory, Certificate Distribution & Global Nominee Reveal** KEY MILESTONE Official e-certificate distribution, closing remarks by dignitaries, group photos, and reveal of NASA Global Nominees!

FLIGHT KIT, EVALUATION & EVENT REGULATIONS

Participant Readiness Checklist, Evaluation Rubric & Code of Conduct

PARTICIPANT FLIGHT KIT & PACKING CHECKLIST

1. Official Identification & Passes

Original College/School Student ID Card, valid Government Photo ID (Aadhaar / Passport / DL), and printed or digital BIAS-NSAC pass.

2. Hardware & Power Equipment

Personal laptops, original power adaptors, multi-plug extension boards (mandatory for team bays), and any specialized microcontrollers or sensors.

3. Pre-Configured Environments

Pre-install your team code IDEs (VS Code, Android Studio), Git, Python/Node runtimes, and Docker before arrival to ensure zero setup downtime.

4. Mountain Climate Preparation

Bhimtal is nestled in Kumaon hills at ~1,370m altitude. Mid-November evenings range between 12°C–16°C. Light woolens and walking shoes required.

OFFICIAL EVALUATION CRITERIA & SCORING MATRIX

CRITERION	WEIGHT	EVALUATION FOCUS & DESCRIPTOR
Innovation & Creativity	25%	Originality of the concept, creative problem framing, and novel approach to space challenges.
Technical Execution	25%	Code cleanliness, robust architecture, functional prototype or hardware demonstration, and feasibility.
NASA Space Data Usage	20%	Meaningful, effective integration and processing of NASA open datasets, earth observation data, or APIs.
Relevance & Impact	15%	Direct alignment with the chosen Problem Statement and potential real-world utility for earth or space.
Presentation & Demo	15%	Clarity and confidence of the 3-minute pitch, 30-sec demo video, slide deck quality, and jury Q&A handling.

ESSENTIAL EVENT GUIDELINES & DUAL PORTAL PROTOCOL

1. DUAL REGISTRATION MANDATORY: All team members must be registered on both the global NASA Space Apps Challenge portal (spaceappschallenge.org) and the BIAS-NSAC college portal for on-campus verification.
2. FRESH WORK REQUIREMENT: All software code, designs, and hardware prototypes must be authored fresh during the 24-hour building period. Submitting pre-built projects is strictly forbidden.
3. OPEN SOURCE & TRANSPARENCY: Teams must publish all code repositories with open-source licensing and provide clear README documentation outlining NASA dataset usage and execution instructions.
4. CODE FREEZE & SUBMISSION: The project submission window commences strictly at 06:00 PM on Day 02. No repository commits or deck revisions are permitted after the submission deadline.
5. GLOBAL NOMINEES ADVANCEMENT: Top winning teams evaluated by our local jury panel will be officially advanced as Global Nominees representing BIAS Bhimtal in the international NASA global judging round.

PORTAL: http://nsac.birlainstitute.co.in/venue-schedule · GLOBAL: https://www.spaceappschallenge.org